THE NOVA RESEARCH CURRICULUM

English

Grade 1 · Term 1

Student edition

Term 1 outcomes: EN-1.6 greetings, EN-1.1 letter sounds, EN-1.5 pencil grip and small letters. Six lessons a week of about 35 minutes.

Lesson notes

EN-1.6 Greets, introduces self and asks for help (Weeks 1–4)

1. **Model:** greet each child by name: "Good morning, Ali." Children answer "Good morning, Miss."
2. **Practise in pairs:** "Hello, my name is ..." / "I am six years old."
3. **Role-play:** asking for help: "Can you help me, please?" "May I go to the washroom?"
4. **Check:** each child introduces self in two sentences while the teacher listens.

Materials: name cards, a puppet. Watch out: "My name Ali" (missing *is*); answering in Urdu. Repeat the full sentence back, do not correct harshly.

EN-1.1 Says the sound of every letter (Weeks 1–12)

Teach sounds in this order, 4–5 sounds a week: **s a t p i n · m d g o c k · e u r h b f l · j v w x y z q**.

1. **Hear it:** say the sound (not the letter name): /s/ as in *sun*. Show a picture card.
2. **Say it:** children say it with an action (/s/ = snake hand).
3. **Find it:** children find objects or pictures that start with the sound.
4. **Blend early (10 min, from Week 3):** blend known sounds: s-a-t → *sat*, p-i-n → *pin*.
5. **Check:** show 5 letters at random; the child says each sound.

Watch out: adding "uh" (/suh/ instead of /s/); mixing b and d. Keep sounds short and clipped.

EN-1.5 Holds a pencil correctly and writes small letters (Weeks 5–12)

1. **Grip:** the "pinch and flip" pencil grip; check every child.
2. **Pre-writing (Weeks 5–6):** trace lines — straight, slanting, curves, circles.
3. **Letter families (Weeks 7–12):** teach letters by shape: c a d g o q (round) · l i t (down strokes) · n m h r b p (hump) · u y j · v w x z k · e s f.
4. **Write:** trace, then copy, then write from memory, saying the sound aloud.

Watched, not tested. Watch out: fist grip; starting letters at the bottom; reversing b/d.

Workbook pages

Page	Outcome	Activity
1	EN-1.6	Draw yourself. Teacher writes "My name is ___" under it; child traces it.
2	EN-1.6	Colour the child who is saying "Thank you" (3 pictures).
3–7	EN-1.1	One page per sound group: circle the pictures that start with the sound (6 pictures each).

Page	Outcome	Activity
8	EN-1.1	Match the letter to the picture (s–sun, a–apple, t–tap, p–pen, i–ink, n–net).
9	EN-1.1	Blend and colour: sat, pin, tap, nap, pit.
10	EN-1.5	Pattern tracing: lines, zig-zags, waves, circles.
11–16	EN-1.5	One page per letter family: trace 3, copy 3, write 2 from memory.

Question bank

EN-1.6

#	Question	Your answer
1	Which is the right way to say hello in the morning?	Good morning / Good night / Goodbye
2	You want to know a friend's name. What do you ask?	What is your name? / How old are you? / Where is it?
3	"My name is Sara." Is this a good way to say your name? True or false.	True / False
4	A friend gives you a pencil. What do you say?	Sorry / Thank you / Goodbye
5	You need help with your bag. What do you say?	Go away / Can you help me, please? / I am six
6	You are leaving school. What do you say?	Goodbye / Good morning / Hello
7	"I am six years old" tells your age. True or false.	True / False
8	[picture: two children waving] What are they saying?	Hello / Sorry / Please
9	"Good night" is said in the morning. True or false.	True / False
10	Your teacher says "How are you?" What do you say?	I am fine, thank you / My name is Ali / Goodbye

EN-1.1

#	Question	Your answer
1	[picture: sun] Which sound does *sun* start with?	s / t / p
2	[picture: apple] Which sound does *apple* start with?	i / a / n
3	[picture: pen] Which letter makes the first sound?	t / p / d
4	[letter m shown] Which picture starts with this sound?	[moon] / [cat] / [bus]
5	[picture: tap] *Tap* starts with /t/. True or false.	True / False
6	[picture: net] *Net* starts with /m/. True or false.	True / False
7	[picture: dog] Which sound does *dog* start with?	b / d / g
8	[picture: umbrella] Which sound does *umbrella* start with?	u / o / a

#	Question	Your answer
9	Blend: s-a-t. Which word is it?	sat / sit / mat
10	Blend: p-i-n. Which picture is it?	[pen] / [pin] / [pan]
11	[picture: fish] Which sound does *fish* start with?	v / f / h
12	[picture: bat] *Bat* starts with /d/. True or false.	True / False

EN-1.5

Watched by the teacher with this checklist, once in Week 8 and once in Week 12: correct grip · starts letters at the top · round letters closed · letters sit on the line · no b/d reversal. Two questions for the app:

#	Question	Your answer
1	[3 pictures of pencil grips] Which is the right way to hold a pencil?	[pinch grip] / [fist grip] / [pencil held at the top]
2	We start writing most letters at the top. True or false.	True / False